

BFS218

Racism and the Digital Age

Understanding Techno-Racism

A short, friendly map to your course site:
what it is, where everything lives, and how
to run a fully asynchronous course on your
own terms.

BFS218

BFS218 Asynchronous Course Site

This instructor-created site carries the weekly teaching for the fully asynchronous section of BFS218. Open it from Blackboard or at rpeart73.github.io/bfs218-async/.

START HERE

Your whole course, in one site

This is the course site for the fully asynchronous section of BFS218. There are no live classes: weekly teaching happens here through experiences, readings, concepts, activities, and checks. Blackboard releases the graded assessments on their scheduled dates and remains the official Seneca platform for announcements, complete assessment instructions, submission, grades, discussions, and course records.



What it is

- Your weekly learning pathway, in working order
- Every source, concept, and self-check in one spot
- Where the weekly teaching happens, beside Blackboard



What it is not

- Not a replacement for Blackboard
- Not where announcements, submissions, discussions, grades, or course records live
- Not a place that collects student submissions or stores grades

How to use this page, on every page

At the top of every page on the site sits a bar labelled How to use this page. Open it for step-by-step instructions written for that exact page: what to click, what may use temporary browser storage, what is never graded, and where to go next. If a page ever feels unfamiliar, that bar is the fastest way to teach yourself.

PRIVACY, ACCESSIBILITY, AND COPYRIGHT

Use it alongside Blackboard

This site does not require an account, collect student submissions, or store grades. The course site's own JavaScript does not transmit your optional name, notes, check answers, or Assignment Start Lab responses. Browser storage may keep a temporary copy on this device, but browser settings, private browsing, clearing site data, shared-device use, or changing devices can prevent or remove it. Download anything you need to keep. Opening an external link, loading external media, or sending the prefilled problem-report email contacts that provider.

Course readings and media are linked for educational use. Copyright remains with the original creators and publishers. Students should access readings through the provided links, Seneca library access, or Blackboard where applicable. Students who experience barriers using the site should use Blackboard and contact the instructor so access can be supported.

START HERE

Open How This Site Works first

It is the first item in the course menu because it explains what this companion site does, what still belongs in Blackboard, what may use temporary browser storage, and how to clear locally stored work on a shared device.

After that short orientation, open Home for the weekly journey. The instructional manuals stay in Site Support whenever you need more detail.

The menu is the map

How This Site Works comes first, before Home, so students meet the site boundaries, privacy controls, accessibility supports, and reset option before beginning the course journey. The rest of the menu is grouped by the work students are trying to do. Home and Calendar orient the term; Weekly Experiences and other immersive spaces hold the teaching environments; source tools support evidence work; assignment and career tools support application; and Site Support keeps the instructional manuals and Report a Problem control.

TOP OF THE MENU

01

How This Site Works

What the site is, what it is not, privacy, and the Clear my saved work control

02

Home

You set the pace: the journey week by week, your driven-weeks progress, and this week

03

Calendar and Due Dates

Every date on one page, the current on-site Coming up banner, and the 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time deadline rule

LEARN EACH WEEK

04

Weekly Experiences

Enter each teaching week through scenes, evidence rooms, decisions, and reflection (Weeks 2 to 12)

05

Course Pathways

How a week runs when you drive it yourself

STUDY THE SOURCES

06

Readings and Media

Every assigned source, as a searchable card

07

Source Practice

Turn any source into practice questions, with a lens

08

Compare Sources

Hold up to three sources side by side, every idea attributed

09

Videos and Podcasts

Scholar media, loaded only when you choose to play

10

Glossary

Every key term, always cited to its reading

11

Concept Flashcards

Flip cards for every week, no course marks

DO THE WORK, AND MORE

12

Starting Your Assignment

All seven graded components, what each asks, and the staged release and due dates

13

Career Choices

The whole course reframed through your own program

14

Course Website Instructions

This guide, online and as a PDF, plus a Report a problem button that emails the instructor

The course as a journey

Home opens with the plain statement of how this section works: **you set the pace, within the deadlines.**

Under it, the journey lays the course out week by week, each station carrying the week's title and its **guiding question**, and a progress line counts the weeks you have driven. Under it, two window cards track your due-date windows in real time (open, days left, closed), and a pace note tells you honestly where the calendar sits relative to your driving, with the shortest way back when you want it. A week counts as driven once you tick its four steps in the YOU DRIVE THIS WEEK checklist on the week page.

- 1 Click any week station to open that week's page.
- 2 Coming back later? Browser storage may let the site reopen where you left off on this device, but browser settings, private browsing, clearing site data, shared-device use, or changing devices can remove that temporary record. Download anything you need to keep.

HOME · THE COURSE JOURNEY, EACH WEEK WITH ITS GUIDING QUESTION

See the course through your program

BFS218 asks how racism travels through technology, and that question lands differently depending on where you are headed. Right on Home you can reframe the whole course around your own program of study, so techno-racism shows up in the tools and systems your field builds and uses every day.

- 1 On Home, find the control that says **See this course through your program**. Pick your program from the dropdown of Seneca programs, grouped by area of study. You can also pick a whole area, or choose **Still exploring**.
- 2 You stay on Home. Nothing navigates away. A short **For your field** panel appears at the top, tying the whole course to your program.
- 3 Each week on the journey gains its own short **For your field** line, and the weeks that matter most to your field are marked **Key for your field**.
- 4 For the deeper write-up, open **Career Choices** from the menu. It gives you three clear sections: program context, how techno-racism connects to that field, and how to use the lens in course work.
- 5 A small chip at the top shows **Viewing as your program**, with a way to change it or turn it off during the current session.

A lens, not a different course

Every student reads the same readings and does the same assessments. The lens only changes how the course is framed for you, it never changes what is required. You can turn it off any time, and the chip at the top of the page is how you do it.

Anatomy of a week

Every week page runs in the order the week is meant to run. Work it top to bottom.

This week in 80 seconds. Most content weeks open with a short animated overview under the week title, made with NotebookLM from that week's readings and reviewed by your instructor. Captions available on the player. It is a fast on-ramp into the week, not a substitute for the readings.

Study Guide. Before the Knowledge Check, each teaching week carries a rehearsal space: a quick warm-up from earlier weeks, explain-it-back cards where you put each key concept in your own words and compare with the reading, and a question ladder that works the week's guiding questions from recall to application. These notes are not submitted or graded and earn no course marks. Browser storage may keep a temporary copy, but browser settings, private browsing, clearing site data, shared-device use, or changing devices can remove it.

Knowledge Check. Every content week closes with an optional self-check that may show a practice result but carries no course marks. Set A and Set B are multiple choice, this week's ideas plus a short review from earlier weeks; Set C is different where the week offers it, with short scenarios, matching, and a written reflection you compare against a model. After you answer, you can say how sure you were, and the summary shows not just what you got right but where a confident answer was actually wrong, the thing most worth fixing. These answers are not submitted or graded. Browser storage may keep a temporary copy, but browser settings, private browsing, clearing site data, shared-device use, or changing devices can remove it; clear or change any answer for a fresh set.

- 1 **This week's focus**, the question and learning sequence that organize the week.
- 2 **Overview & How this week works**, read this first; it tells you what to do and in what order.
- 3 **Purpose & Outcomes**, what you should be able to do by the end. Test yourself against these sentences.
- 4 **Guiding Questions**, carry at least one with you into the readings.
- 5 **Key Concepts**, each explained and cited to that week's reading, so you always know where an idea comes from.
- 6 **Readings**, full citation and a button. Open access, Seneca Library, Read on Blackboard, or Revisit from an earlier week.
- 7 **The Experience**, an interactive chapter sequence embedded on the page. Enter it, make choices, inspect the evidence, and use the Arrow keys to move between chapters.
- 8 **The Activity**, press Start and follow the prompts. Practice, not assessment.
- 9 **Reflect**, a short prompt (one or two sentences) to close the week.
- 10 **You can now**, the week's closing checklist. Tick what you can genuinely do; anything left unticked shows exactly what to revisit. Reset any time.

Seneca
POLYTECHNIC

BFS218 Companion

Reading Lens

Listen

Switch section

Refresh

ASYNCHRONOUS · SELF-PACED

FALL 2026

ORIENT

How This Site Works

Home

Course Pathways

Calendar and Due Dates

WEEKLY JOURNEY

Week 2

See this course through your program: General stream / no program

COMING UP

Open calendar

Term marker (September 8): First day of classes

Assignment released (September 21): Map Exchange

Assignment released (Septem

Pause

Return to Previous Screen

Home

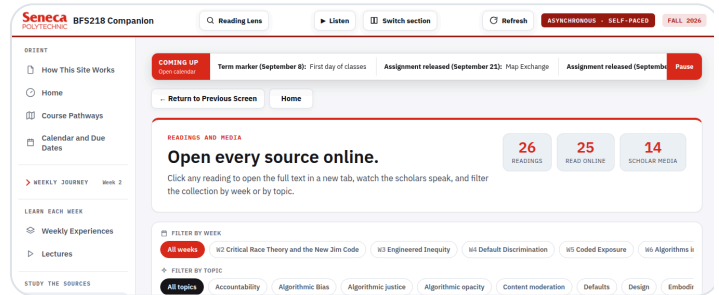


A WEEK PAGE · EVERYTHING IN WORKING ORDER, TOP TO BOTTOM

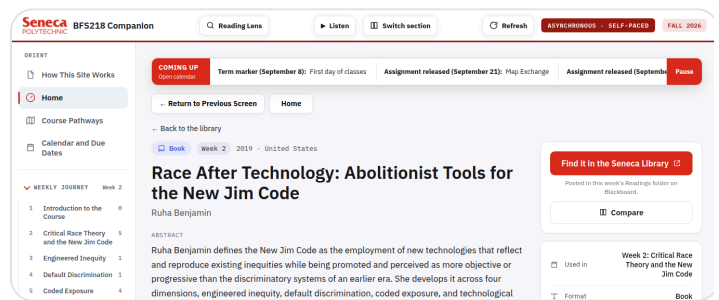
Every source, as a card

The library holds every course reading: what it is, what it argues, how long it takes, and how to reach it.

- 1 Search any author, title, or idea.
- 2 Filter to one week with the week strip, or browse by format.
- 3 Click a card for the reading's page: core idea, plain-language abstract, level and length, and where the text lives.
- 4 Press the red button to open the reading. A Source page button appears where a separate source or DOI exists.
- 5 Bookmark a reading to your Saved shelf. Browser storage may keep a temporary copy, but browser settings, private browsing, clearing site data, shared-device use, or changing devices can remove it; note anything you need to keep.



EVERY SOURCE AS A CARD, SEARCHABLE BY WEEK

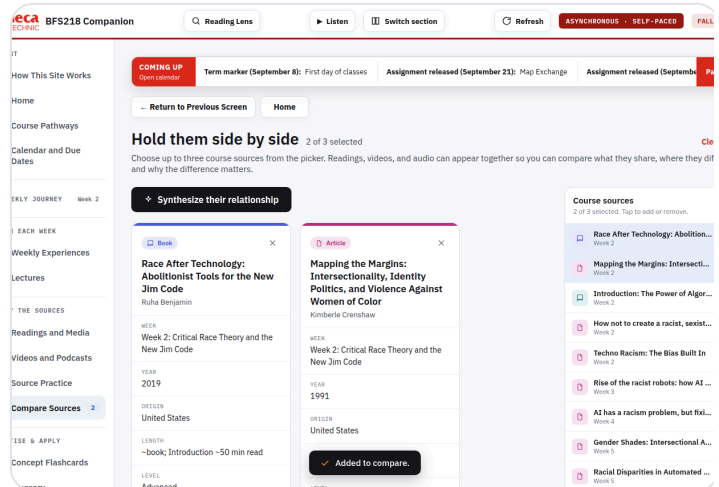


A READING PAGE · CORE IDEA, ABSTRACT, AND THE OPEN BUTTON

COMPARE SOURCES

Hold up to three sources side by side

- 1 Open Compare from the menu, or press Compare on any reading page.
- 2 Pick up to three readings. Each becomes a column: week, year, origin, length, level, and core idea.
- 3 With two or more selected, press **Synthesize their relationship**. The site explains how they speak to each other, every idea attributed.
- 4 With three, it takes the pairings one at a time, then asks what only appears when all three are on the table.
- 5 Remove a reading with the × on its column, or Clear all to start over.



EACH PAIRING EXPLAINED, EVERY IDEA ATTRIBUTED

Turn any source into practice

Choose a reading, choose a lens, and answer. Every answer comes back with a short explanation grounded in the reading itself, so a wrong answer still teaches you something specific.

LENS 01

Thematic

What it is about.

LENS 02

Argument

What it claims, and why.

LENS 03

Context

Where it sits in the field and the course.

GLOSSARY

Never defined out of thin air

- Browse by week (including the closing weeks) or search any term.
- Every definition carries a citation to that week's assigned reading.
- The *Scholars this week* strip introduces the people behind the readings. Click a name to jump to their reading.

CONCEPT FLASHCARDS

Practice, no course marks

- Pick a week, or take all weeks together.
- Flip the cards: term on the front, definition and citation on the back.
- For question practice, each week page closes with its own Knowledge Check. The interface may show correctness or a practice result, but answers are not submitted or graded and earn no course marks. Browser storage may keep a temporary copy, but browser settings, private browsing, clearing site data, shared-device use, or changing devices can remove it; use the practice to see what to reread.



Weekly Experiences hub. The experiences for Weeks 2 to 12 all live in one place. Open Weekly Experiences from the menu and choose a week to re-enter it without hunting.

HANDS - ON

The studios & labs

Alongside the weekly activities, the site carries hands-on labs. Each one tells you what you are doing and why before you start. The companion site does not submit or grade this lab work; it earns no course marks.

Evidence Transfer Lab

Move a claim from source to argument, deliberately.

Accountability Chain Lab

Trace who answers for a harm, link by link.

Self-Check Studio

Package your studio work as a Word document to keep.

THREE MORE WAYS INTO THE LIBRARY

Browse it however you think

By week

Everything, week by week.

Tiles

The whole library as a wall you can scan.

Index

The alphabetical list.

Make a small, realistic start plan

Use [the seven current assignment guides](#) for the complete tasks, marking criteria and submission steps. The release and due dates are listed below. Blackboard holds your submissions, feedback and grades.

What it creates. Fixed course rules combine your answers into a personal starting point, course-specific next actions, a success target for the next work session, useful questions, and the right human support routes. The plan also explains why each pathway was selected. No AI is used.

How your plan is handled. The companion site's own code does not upload, submit, score, grade, or send your name, context, answers, or plan to the instructor. Browser storage may keep a temporary copy on this device, but browser settings, private browsing, clearing site data, shared-device use, or changing devices can prevent or remove it. Print or save the plan as a PDF, or copy it as text.

BFS218 | RACISM AND THE DIGITAL AGE

Assignment start plan for Jordan

Map Exchange | Created July 13, 2026 | Planning support only
Program or field: Social Service Worker | Blackboard due date you recorded: October 8 at 11:59 p.m.

What you are working toward
Build the weekly habit of noticing how an ordinary digital system shapes people differently.

Your starting idea or question: I want to use the Week 3 case but keep the claim narrow.

Your starting point

- Assignment: Map Exchange
- Program or field context: Social Service Worker
- Due date and time copied from Blackboard: October 8 at 11:59 p.m.
- Planned work session: Tuesday at 7 p.m. in the library
- What feels difficult: I do not know what sources or evidence to use. I am stuck on the first sentence or paragraph.
- Your exact description of the sticking point: I have a topic, but I cannot tell which source should anchor my first paragraph.
- What you marked ready: I have the official Blackboard brief open. I have relevant course notes or weekly work. I wrote down the exact due date and time.
- What you have already done or collected: I opened the brief, reviewed Week 3 notes, and saved one possible case.

A PERSONAL PLAN • READY TO PRINT OR SAVE AS PDF

Choose the amount of support you need. For most BFS218 assignments, use the lab for a quick PDF plan or the Starter Studio for a more detailed Word preparation pack. For **Digital Decision Scenarios**, the lab creates readiness steps only. It does not generate, preview, or rehearse graded answers.

Blackboard remains official. Always return there for the complete brief, rubric, due date, submission link, and recorded grade. The lab helps you begin; it does not write the assignment or replace the instructor's requirements.

GOOD HABITS FOR THE TERM

A rhythm that works

STEP 1

Open the week page early and read the overview.

STEP 2

Do the readings with one guiding question in hand.

STEP 3

Enter the experience and follow its chapters.

STEP 4

Do the activity.

STEP 5

Tick the You can now checklist honestly.

Before each assignment, use **Compare** on the readings you plan to write about, and run the **Knowledge Check** at the end of those weeks.

Good to know

- Works on phones, tablets, and laptops, and is designed for keyboard navigation.
- Browser storage may keep a temporary copy of your saved shelf, notes, and check answers on this device; this companion-site work is not submitted or graded and earns no course marks, though checks may show a practice result.
- Browser settings, private browsing, clearing site data, shared-device use, or changing devices can prevent or remove that copy.
- If the site looks stale after an announced update, refresh the page once.

THE ONE RULE THAT MATTERS

When in doubt, Blackboard wins.

BFS218 asynchronous course site. Blackboard remains the official course platform for submissions, grades, announcements, discussions, and course records.

QUICK REFERENCE

Where to go for what

Start this week's work	Home ▶ click the week ▶ work top to bottom
Find a source fast	Readings and Media ▶ search or week strip
See how sources connect	Compare Sources ▶ pick up to three
Test yourself on a source	Source Practice ▶ pick a lens
Look up a term	Glossary ▶ search
Drill before an assessment	Concept Flashcards ▶ pick the weeks
Re-enter the week's experience	Weekly Experiences ▶ pick the week
Submit anything / check grades	Blackboard, always

Reading Lens and other study supports

The **Reading Lens** button at the top of every page opens reading supports that apply across the whole site: text size from 75 to 175 percent, comfortable spacing, a high-legibility font, nine page tints (including a blue light filter that warms the whole screen), a reading ruler that follows your pointer (choose its width, pin it in place, and drag it by hand), a large-print magnifier docked at the bottom of the screen, and read-aloud in your choice of the voices on your own device; a Listen button also sits at the top of every page. Inside an experience, use the header's **A minus**, **A plus**, and **Reset** controls to set experience text from 100 to 200 percent or restart the experience. The Accessibility panel offers Light, Soft grey, Warm, and High contrast screen themes, plus a high-legibility font and reduced motion. Dense chapters scroll vertically at readable size instead of shrinking their text. Browser storage may keep a temporary copy of these choices on this device; browser settings, private browsing, clearing site data, shared-device use, or changing devices can reset them. A Reset all supports button returns everything to default.

Do not save your work on this site. Notes and check answers are not submitted or graded and earn no course marks; checks may show a practice result. Browser storage may keep a temporary copy on this device, but browser settings, private browsing, clearing site data, shared-device use, or changing devices can remove it. Draft anything graded in your own documents, and at the end of any week download your notes with **Generate Your Weekly Notes**. On a shared or lab computer, the How This Site Works page has a one-click **Clear my saved work** control.

Week pages start folded. Each week opens as a clean map of headings. Press the button beside any heading to open just that section, up to two sections stay open at once (opening a third folds the earliest), and you can fold any section back down when you finish it. Sections fold again when you leave the week, so every visit starts from the clean map, and jumping to a section from the side list opens it for you.

Your study compass. When browser storage is available, the home page may read activity temporarily kept on this device (weeks opened, checks tried, reflections written) and offer up to three next steps. It uses a few fixed rules, not AI, and the course site's own JavaScript does not transmit that activity. You can add your first name so the site greets you; browser storage may keep a temporary local copy. Browser settings, private browsing, clearing site data, shared-device use, or changing devices can remove it, and Clear my saved work removes it when present.

Coming up and phone access. The current schedule stays at the top while you move through the site. Pause freezes the message exactly where it is and keeps the text visible. Select the persistent Coming Up banner to open Calendar and Due Dates; no dialog opens automatically. On a phone, Calendar and Due Dates offers a live calendar subscription. How This Site Works gives you the same site link to share or copy to another device. Blackboard remains the official source if a date changes.

Work inside every 3D activity. Each week uses the visual style that best fits its task: technical inspection, workshop, civic policy, or cartographic mapping. Drag to turn the scene, pinch or scroll to zoom, or use the view buttons. The default view shows the whole environment. Numbered explanations sit below the model so they do not block the evidence. Weeks with simulations let you change inputs, run repeated trials, and compare

uncertain outcomes. A positive result can occur, but the underlying rules still shape which outcomes are more likely. The experience uses the same week model so the teaching and activity stay aligned.

If something breaks. Weekly Experiences open full screen. Close the experience to return to the course page and menu. If a model, recording, or video will not load, or anything looks wrong, use Report a problem on How This Site Works. It opens a prefilled email to the instructor; sending it contacts your email provider and the instructor. No phone number is shown. If the site is unavailable, everything required for the course is also on Blackboard.

Privacy. No third-party content loads automatically. A third-party service is contacted only when you choose to open an external link or load external media. YouTube uses its privacy-enhanced player, and each external service applies its own privacy practices.

Experiments. Most weekly activities in BFS218 open with a short experiment: commit to a prediction, run it, read what actually happened, and see your own prediction mirrored back. The mirror names the thinking move you used, and across weeks it shows the pattern in your first instincts. The companion site does not submit or grade it; it earns no course marks.

[Current assessment instructions, dates, submission steps, and grading criteria](#)

Assessment release and submission dates

All dates are in 2026 and use Eastern Time. Assessments open at 12:01 a.m.; submissions are due at 11:59 p.m. You can preview the public website, but Blackboard controls the assessment opening dates. Larger tasks have longer working windows. Instructions identify earlier feedback to use when one task builds on another.

BFS218 SYA deadlines. All times are Eastern Time (ET).

Assignment	Opens	Posted deadline	48-hour window ends
1. Digital Systems Field Notes Portfolio 1 (10%)	September 8, 2026 12:01 a.m. ET	September 18, 2026 11:59 p.m. ET	September 20, 2026 11:59 p.m. ET
2. Digital Decision Scenarios (20%)	October 1, 2026 12:01 a.m. ET	October 13, 2026 11:59 p.m. ET	October 15, 2026 11:59 p.m. ET
3. Canadian Technology Investigation (20%)	October 1, 2026 12:01 a.m. ET	October 20, 2026 11:59 p.m. ET	October 22, 2026 11:59 p.m. ET
4. Digital Systems Field Notes Portfolio 2 (10%)	November 2, 2026 12:01 a.m. ET	November 13, 2026 11:59 p.m. ET	November 15, 2026 11:59 p.m. ET
5. Design the Repair (20%)	November 16, 2026 12:01 a.m. ET	November 27, 2026 11:59 p.m. ET	November 29, 2026 11:59 p.m. ET
6. Personal Cartography (15%)	November 26, 2026 12:01 a.m. ET	December 11, 2026 11:59 p.m. ET	No automatic window
7. Final Learning Reflection (5%)	December 7, 2026 12:01 a.m. ET	December 13, 2026 11:59 p.m. ET	No automatic window

The first three assessments total 50%; their standard submission windows close by October 22. This schedule allows ten calendar days for marking before the second half begins November 2. No assessment is due during Study Week, October 26 to 30. The final scheduled submission is December 13.

Your asynchronous Blackboard learning blocks

You choose when to study within an available block. The companion website stays open for preview and practice; Blackboard releases the learning modules progressively. Once open, a module remains available.

- Week 1: open now.
- Week 2: Sep 8.
- Weeks 3 and 4: Sep 21.
- Weeks 5 and 6: Oct 5.
- Week 7: Oct 19.
- Study Week, October 26 to 30: no new release or required deadline.
- Weeks 8 and 9: Nov 2.
- Weeks 10 and 11: Nov 16.
- Week 12: Nov 30.
- Week 13: Dec 7.
- Week 14: Dec 13.

Seven of fourteen weekly modules open before Study Week. The other seven open in smaller releases throughout the remaining term, not all at once in November.

Deadlines and Extensions

Posted deadlines

Submit through Blackboard by the posted deadline. All dates and times use Eastern Time. Saving a draft is not the same as submitting; check for Blackboard's submission confirmation.

Regular assignments: 48 hours without a penalty

Regular assignments have an automatic 48-hour submission window after the posted deadline, without a grade penalty. You do not need permission to use this window. Each assessment shows its posted deadline and the exact date and time the window ends. Blackboard may label a submission made during this window as late; that label does not mean a penalty applies.

Request an extension BEFORE the posted deadline

Routine extension requests must reach me before the original posted deadline. The 48-hour submission window does not extend the deadline for requesting an extension. Routine requests made during or after that window will not be approved. A request made before the deadline does not guarantee approval.

After the 48-hour window

Work submitted after the standard 48-hour window receives zero unless an extension or exception has been approved. Blackboard may still allow an upload so approved exceptions can be handled; an available submission box does not extend the acceptance deadline.

Unexpected emergencies and accommodations

If an unexpected emergency arises, or prevents you from contacting me earlier, contact me as soon as possible. Exceptional circumstances are considered individually. Approved accommodations remain in effect and determine your applicable arrangements. Contact me privately rather than posting personal information in the course-question forum.

Scheduled live assessments

Scheduled live assessments or presentation components do not have an automatic 48-hour window. Contact me before the scheduled time if you cannot attend, or as soon as possible if an emergency prevents advance contact. Any written or recorded alternative follows the submission instructions for that assessment.

Final projects and the Final Learning Reflection

Final projects are due December 11, 2026 at 11:59 p.m. Eastern. The Final Learning Reflection is due December 13, 2026 at 11:59 p.m. Eastern. These final assignments have no automatic 48-hour window. Routine extension requests must arrive before the posted deadline. Approved accommodations and exceptional circumstances are handled individually.

If Blackboard prevents submission

Contact me promptly and keep evidence of the problem, such as the error message and time. Email is for reporting the issue, not the normal assessment submission route. I will explain how to proceed if a technical problem requires another arrangement.

[Read the policy and exact course deadlines online.](#)